

**Bismarck's last battle**
Raked by gunfire from the British battleships, the crippled *Bismarck* puts up a desperate last fight.

KEY

**GERMAN FORCES**

1 German battleship: SMS *Bismarck*

1 German battlecruiser

German U-boat screen

**BRITISH FORCES DURING FINAL PURSUIT**
Destroyers and other small ships not shown.

1 British aircraft carrier

1 British battleship

1 British cruiser or battlecruiser

1 wave of British torpedo bombers

1 British reconnaissance plane

**A reconnaissance plane from Northern Ireland spots the *Bismarck*, letting the British units renew their pursuit**

**A second bombing raid by *Ark Royal*'s Swordfish torpedo bombers damages the *Bismarck*'s steering**

**Admiral Tovey leads the pursuit of the *Bismarck* on board the battleship *King George V*. He is joined by the battleship *Rodney* and heavy cruiser *Norfolk***

**Force H, including aircraft carrier *Ark Royal*, heads north from Gibraltar to block the *Bismarck*'s escape**

**Cruiser *Sheffield*, shadowing the *Bismarck*, is mistakenly attacked by *Ark Royal*'s aircraft, but escapes damage**

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## 2 THE BISMARCK IS SPOTTED

After a break of over 30 hours, a Catalina flying boat from Loch Erne in Northern Ireland spots the *Bismarck*. Carrier *Ark Royal*, approaching from the south, launches Swordfish torpedo bombers against the battleship, damaging her steering.

## 3 THE END OF THE BISMARCK

Her rudders jammed, the *Bismarck* steams in large circles into the path of the approaching British battleships. Mortally damaged by torpedo attacks from the cruisers and destroyers and heavy fire from the battleships, the *Bismarck* finally succumbs.

**Heavy cruiser *Dorsetshire* arrives from the south to join the attack. With *Bismarck*'s crew already scuttling the battleship, *Dorsetshire*'s torpedoes finally finish her off**

***Rodney* and *King George V* close in on the incapacitated *Bismarck*. Despite heavy fire causing great damage, *Bismarck* does not surrender. Running low on fuel, the battleships head home**

**Her steering irretrievably damaged, *Bismarck* steams in circles. Pounded by guns and torpedoes, the *Bismarck* sinks at last with heavy loss of life**

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